

MGT 406: Leading People

Fall 2025, Executive MBA

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Course description. In this course, students will learn and develop key leadership skills.

Learning methodology. Case analysis, articles, in-class exercises and discussion, written assignments.

Course objectives. (1) Apply research-based knowledge to challenges facing managers and leaders; (2) Gain self-awareness of your current level of proficiency in key skills; (3) Accelerate development and progress toward one individualized leadership skill/goal; (4) Apply course concepts to your teams throughout the MBA program and beyond.

Course website. rady.instructure.com (Canvas)

Course materials. (1) Course Reader; (2) Additional materials provided on Canvas; (3) Slack

Attendance and technology. Full on-time attendance and appropriate use of technology are required.

No AI-derived work (e.g., chatgpt) is permitted in this course.

How to prep cases. Read carefully; note important points you would like to discuss in class; put yourself in the shoes of the main protagonist(s), and consider how your decision making and actions would proceed under similar circumstances; consider analogies to your own work experiences, and prepare to draw these parallels in class and/or on Slack.

How to prep readings. Consider how each article relates to its accompanying case; reflect on how the lessons from the article might apply to your current/future work environment.

How you are graded. 40% participation, 35% PDP, 25% Team Paper.

Participation. Your class contributions are extremely important to your and your classmates' learning. At the end of the course, your classmates (50%) and your professor (50%) will grade your participation. Your professor will consult with your TA and consider attendance and completion of ungraded assignments. Each of your classmates will respond to a prompt similar to the following: "Please choose a fair class participation grade for each student in your class. Consider the following factors as you see fit: How was the quality of the student's contributions in full class discussions, small group discussions, and on Slack? Were their comments useful, on point, and/or controversial in a productive way? Did they share relevant experiences from their own background and work history? Did they listen carefully to their classmates, and engage them in thoughtful discussions? Were they well-prepared for class? To what extent did they provide value to your and others' experience in the class?"

Personal Development Plan (PDP). An individually-completed plan for your leadership development. It contains (A) a self portrait, (B) a goal, and (C) an action plan for obtaining your goal. Details are available on the course website.

Team Paper. One paper will be submitted per study group. In this paper, you will analyze your teams through the lens of 3 course topics, demonstrating your mastery of the material. Here, you will also offer prescriptive advice for how to improve your study group's performance in the future.

COURSE SCHEDULE (Assignments/instructions are in the "Assignments" section of course website)

Week 0 (Online Module):

Complete Initial Survey, BFI, and BESSI (Important: save electronic copies of your feedback from each of these 3 surveys; you will use this for your PDP assignment)
Sign up for Slack and post your Intro as a reply to the Intros Thread

Week 1 (Online Module):

(1) Watch 9 minute RBS video; (2) Read "How to play to your strengths"; (3) Complete Steps 1-3 of the "Reflected Best Self Assignment"
Do not turn anything in. Completing the RBS is necessary for a successful PDP.

OCTOBER 12 meeting:

Topic 1: Self-Awareness, Other-Awareness, and Leadership Styles

Case – Read before class: Coach Knight; Coach K

Read before class: The Power of Healthy Relationships at Work; Don't Underestimate the Power of Kindness at Work

Topic 2: Personality and Skills

No additional prep beyond the surveys you completed in the Week 0 module

Topic 3: Conflict and Negotiation

Case – Read before class: Name Your Price (Monroe and Jim)

Read before class: Should You Make the First Offer?

Due by meeting: Complete the Name Your Price (Monroe and Jim) case assignment (individual assignment). Bring an electronic or paper copy of your responses to class

Week 3 (Online Module):

Meet with Study Group to Discuss Your Personality and Skills (approx. 30 mins)

Week 4 (Online Module):

Complete the Individual Portions of the Team Charter

Complete the Team Charter with your Study Group

(1) Watch the brief instruction video

(2) Complete the activity with your Study Group (approx. 1 hour)

Week 5 (Online Module):

Complete the PDP Workshop with your Study Group

- (1) Generate 2-3 potential goals that you could pursue in your Personal Development Plan
- (2) Watch the brief PDP workshop instruction video
- (3) Complete the activity with your Study Group (approximately 45 mins)

NOVEMBER 9 meeting:

Topic 1: Emotional Intelligence

Read before class: Time for Happiness; Handling Negative Emotions in a Way that's Good for Your Team

Topic 2: Teams

In-class activity: Everest Simulation (Follow your TA's instructions for simulation preparation)

Read before class: Leading Teams

Week 7 (Online Module): No activity; PDP due this week

NOVEMBER 16: **Personal Development Plan (PDP) Due**

Week 8 (Online Module): Complete Sears Auto Centers Activity with your Study Group

- (1) Read Sears Auto Centers Case
- (2) Design a new reward system for Sears Auto Centers with your study group and Slack DM your instructor a single slide describing your Study Group's plan. (30 minute time limit; these are not expected to look polished)

Week 9 (Online Module): No activity; Thanksgiving

DECEMBER 7 meeting:

Topic 1: Ethics Part 1

Case – Read before class: Martha McCaskey

Read before class: A New Model for Ethical Leadership

Topic 2: Ethics Part 2

Case – Read before class: Sears Auto Centers

Read before class: On the Folly of Rewarding A While Hoping for B

Topic 3: Power and Influence

Case – Read before class: Donna Dubinsky

Read before class: Don't Let Power Corrupt You; Amplifying Your Colleagues' Voices Benefits Everyone

DECEMBER 10: Peer Course Contribution Survey Due

DECEMBER 13: Team Paper Due

Academic Integrity. Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind. The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

Students with Disabilities. A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member. The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. No accommodations can be implemented retroactively. Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.